David Okai Sarpong

BSc student at Rhodes University: Mathematics, Mathematical Statistics and Information Systems

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PROFILE

I am a Mathematics, Mathematical Statistics and Information Systems student at Rhodes University, interested in applying quantitative methods, statistical modelling and technology to solve real-world problems.

My interests lie at the intersection of data analytics, data science and quantitative finance. I enjoy exploring complex problems, working with data and continuously developing my technical capabilities.

EDUCATION

Now
Rhodes University
BSc: Mathematics, Mathematical Statistics, Information Systems
Second year, Makhanda, Eastern Cape

Before
Queen's College Boys' High School

Earlier
Queen's College Boys' Primary School
Graduated Cum Laude

EXPERIENCE

Jul to Sep 2026
FNB App Academy
Programme participant
A hands-on programme focused on practical, industry-relevant technology and problem-solving skills.

Jul to Aug 2026
Codveda Technologies
Data Analytics Intern
Applied statistical methods and analysis tools to real datasets.

May 2026
Future Interns
Data Analytics Intern (remote)
Cleaned and joined relational datasets in Python and Pandas, and traced a baseline customer churn rate of about 22%.

2026
JSE Investment Challenge
2026 cohort
Running a simulated investment portfolio, applying statistics to real market conditions.

LEADERSHIP AND ROLES

In progress
Founder, Rhodes Statistics Club
Rhodes University
Working towards establishing the club. It is not yet an established organisation.

Peer Mentor and Tutor
Rhodes University
Mentoring and tutoring other students.

Residence Student Assistant
Rhodes University

International Representative
Botha House (Founders Hall), Rhodes University
Representing international students in the house.

Referee Liaison Committee Member
Rhodes University Hockey Club

PROJECTS

R, Python
01 Statistical Simulation & Central Limit Theorem Analysis
Simulations of probability distributions and stochastic behaviour, written in R and Python to see course theory play out over many trials.

Python, Pandas	**02 Customer Churn Analysis** A data analytics project from the Future Interns internship: cleaning and joining relational datasets to trace a baseline customer churn rate.
React, Vite, Tailwind CSS	**03 Personal Portfolio Website** This website: a React site built to show who I am beyond my CV, with an interactive hockey journey, certification milestones and a chat assistant.
Annual initiative	**04 Queen's College Think Tank: GBV Awareness Campaign** The annual GBV Orange Day awareness campaign I helped organise through the Queen's College Think Tank, built around a yearly derby.
In progress	**05 Rhodes University Statistics Club** A club I am working towards establishing at Rhodes to encourage statistical learning and collaboration beyond the classroom.

CERTIFICATES

- **MATLAB Onramp**, MathWorks June 2026
- **Ikamva Digital: AI Basics**, Microsoft June 2026
- **Ikamva Digital: Essentials in Cybersecurity**, Microsoft June 2026
- **Ikamva Digital**, Microsoft June 2026
- **Data Science & Analytics Internship**, Future Interns 19 June 2026
- **Statistics Onramp**, MathWorks August 2026
- **HTML5 Development Fundamentals**, Mzansi Digital Learning August 2026
- **Claude Academy: AI Fluency, Framework & Foundations**, Anthropic August 2026
- **Claude Academy: Claude Code 101**, Anthropic August 2026
- **Mind My Money Workshop**, Stanlib and PM Skillshouse L&D 31 August 2026 (attendance)
- **SQL for Data Analysis**, LinkedIn Learning 26 September 2026
- **R for Data Science: Analysis and Visualization**, LinkedIn Learning 27 September 2026

LETTERS OF RECOMMENDATION

- **Letter of Recommendation: Data Science & Analytics Internship**, Future Interns 19 June 2026

Viewable at itsdavidketcham.github.io/career

PROGRAMMES

- **FNB App Academy** Jul to Sep 2026
- **FlyRank AI Fluency Programme**

ACHIEVEMENTS

- Academic Full Scroll
- Cum Laude, Queen's College Boys' Primary School
- Leadership Full Scroll
- Botha House Most Valuable Member
- Rhodes Hockey Bursary
- Rhodes University Hockey First Team, 3rd place at USSA
- Half Colours, provincial Under-13 hockey
- World Scholar's Cup: qualified for the Global Round, Top 50
- First place with the debate team

SKILLS

Programming Python, R, MATLAB
Web development JavaScript (ES6+), HTML, CSS, React
Data and statistics Statistical modelling, Data visualisation
Mathematics Multivariable calculus, Differential equations
Databases SQL
Tools Git, UML

LANGUAGES AND INTERESTS

Languages English, Xhosa, Twi, Afrikaans
Interests Data analytics, Data science, Quantitative finance, Financial technology, Statistical modelling, Mathematics, Programming, Financial markets, Hockey, Running, Board games, Call of Duty, Rubik's Cube solving